



Australia Awards

REAP Form (for Applicants of 2026 Intake)

The Re-entry Action Plan (REAP) is a formal document that represents a scholar's commitment to honor the conditions of the Australia Awards Scholarships (see Scholarship Handbook section 4.2). It is a mechanism that allows scholars to apply what they have learned in Australia to contribute to Philippine development through a meaningful project in an organisation or community.

- I. RELEVANCE OF THE REAP.** The REAP should clearly and succinctly explain how the delivery of its proposed output or outputs will improve the services or performance of the Host Organisation and ultimately contribute to the achievement of the goals set in the Philippine Government's Ambisyon Natin 2040, and the goals of the Australian Government in the Philippines.

Fill out the following sections after reading these required documents.

Name of Proponent	Janina Marie C. Capistrano
REAP Title	Closing the Loop: Creating a Project Closing Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) Tool for the Rail Unified Project Management Office
REAP Objective	Improve DOTr Railway Sector's project management system by creating an end-project Monitoring and Evaluation tool which will enable the Rail UPMO to measure planned versus actual outcomes, and capture lessons learned in closing of projects, to be completed within a year.
Name of Host Organisation	Department of Transportation
Description of the Host Organisation and relation to REAP	The Department of Transportation (DOTr) is the executive branch's arm mandated to promote, develop, and regulate the a dependable and coordinated network of transportation system in the country. Pursuant to the current administration's medium-term plan of improving infrastructure, the DOTr has been developing and implementing railway infrastructure projects which are aligned with the National Transport Policy and the Philippine Development Plan's (PDP) goal of delivering sustainable, resilient, integrated, and modernized infrastructure facilities and services which will help improve the quality of life of the people. I am currently serving both as a Chief Transportation Development Officer of the O&M Strategy Management and Monitoring Division (or OMSMMD, currently the Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) arm) and

	OIC-Project Manager II for the LRT Projects Implementation Unit (LRT PIU) of the DOTr's Railway Unified Project Management Office (Rail UPMO). As OMSMMD/M&E Division Chief and PM, I am supporting the Rail UPMO Head and the Office of the Undersecretary for Railways in both the project delivery and governance domains of the implementation of railway infrastructure projects. Upon completion of the program, this REAP shall be facilitated and implemented with the clearance of the mentioned principals and with the cooperation of all Project Management Offices.
BACKGROUND INFORMATION	
Problem / Opportunity	The proposed REAP aims to fill in the gap of the absence of an effective M&E tool to serve as a guide for ongoing and future infrastructure projects. In my role as OIC-PM II of the LRT PIU, I had the unique opportunity to manage two of the first three completed or partially-completed infrastructure projects of the Railways Sector under the Build! Build! Build! and the Build Better More program of the previous and current administrations – the LRT-2 East Extension (L2EE) Project and the LRT-1 Cavite Extension (L1CE) Project (Package 1 or P1). Currently, L2EE is already operating and at the financial closure stage while the L1CE P1 is at the punchlisting and nearing handover stage. In early 2024, when we were preparing the document submissions for the investment re-approval for L2EE's project implementation extension (period needed for financial closure), we were asked by the National Economic Development Authority (NEDA) to submit a Final Completion Report which evaluates and reports on the performance of the project during this project closure stage. At that time, we did not have that report ready yet and there was no tool available for use by the Railways Sector, understandably because the L2EE is the first project to ever be completed again in the last decade, after the completion LRT-1 North Extension Project by an attached agency, Light Rail Transit Authority (LRTA), in 2010. Additionally, for the L1CE P1, we have already reported on the performance of the extended line, but in form of piecemeal reports such as ridership reports. In an effort to monitor the accessibility of the built structures, I have asked our engineers and architects to do further site visits in the stations to get feedback from passengers and, as needed, we were able to give feedback to our counterparts on the measures needed to ensure a more convenient travel experience for the passengers. The problems arising from the absence of an M&E tool for closing of projects do not just end with the non-submission of needed reports, but, more importantly, it does not allow the sector to capture all relevant project data which will ensure alignment of actual outcomes to the intended outcome results during project feasibility study or appraisal. In addition, there is also an opportunity not being utilized in the form of sharing of list of learned lessons which can be a useful guide for other ongoing or to-be-developed projects. The opportunity to implement this REAP will help the DOTr Rail UPMO/Railways Sector in its management of a portfolio of projects which are all about to finish from 2025-2031, including big-ticket priority infrastructure projects such as the Metro Manila Subway

	(MMSP) and North-South Commuter Railway (NSCR) Project, and other future railway projects which are identified already and those which will result from the ongoing 30-Year Railway Transport Masterplan study. Also, the REAP will enable improvement of inputs for other agency reports such as the DBM Project DIME and the NEDA PIPOL.
BENEFICIARIES	
Direct Beneficiary	The direct beneficiary of the REAP is the Rail UPMO, specifically with the help of different project teams within the Rail UPMO with already completed and target partial operations in the next five years such as the L1CE, L2EE, MRT-7, Common Station, and NSCR. The REAP will provide the Rail UPMO with an instrument by which to measure the effectiveness of its projects, while documenting and getting the lessons learned from each other. In effect, it will allow the Rail UPMO to compare desired from actual project and portfolio which is important for better project development and network planning in preparation for other projects which are already in the pipeline. The REAP will also provide a formative or process evaluation tool for the Rail UPMO to measure effectiveness and improve the current state of its project delivery and project management systems. With help and feedback from project teams and the future passengers on several impact domains (cost, technical, operational, economic, environmental, social etc.), the output of the improved M&E system in Rail UPMO should translate to delivery of a more accessible, safe, and efficient railway system which is truly responsive to the needs of the public.
Gender Equality, Disability, and Social Inclusion (GEDSI)	The proposed REAP aims to provide the Rail UPMO with an M&E tool which should cover different project domains as mentioned above, including risks and issues on GEDSI which affected and may affect both project implementation and actual railway service delivery and customer experience. For example, in the realm of project management, the M&E tool should require inputs on gender-inclusive and PWD-friendly facility considerations in the built railway stations, even if these factors may or may not have been part of the initial design and construction of the infrastructure. Additionally, if these factors are considered in planning and implementation, the extent by which the projects actually exhibited the intended outcomes should also be required in a portion of the tool which should be about social inclusivity analysis of the benefits of the project (e.g., data on gender and social profile of riders, evaluation or feedback from PWD groups or passengers on the accessibility of the station facilities, etc.).
Climate Change Adaptation, Disaster Risk Reduction and Environmental Protection	The REAP shall be able to help improve the Rail UPMO's monitoring of its environmental protection contribution by including a section on reporting about environmental impact of the project. The DOTr currently has Nationally-Determined Contribution (NDC) of how many tons of CO₂ or other GHG emission (net of emission during construction) will be reduced with the completion of its several projects, and the railways sector has one of the biggest share in this part of the climate action plan. By including a section on environmental impact, the Rail UPMO will be able to support its

	environmental and climate change sustainability reports. Similarly, a portion on the listing of disaster risk reduction measures or facilities per project, or a passenger perception survey on the presence of those features in the project assets may also be included in the tool.
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II. IMPACT AND SUSTAINABILITY OF THE ORGANISATIONAL OUTCOME OF THE REAP. The REAP should produce an output/s that will help the Host Organisation improve their services or performance. These improvements are the outcome/s of your REAP. You should therefore clearly articulate your strategies for the Host Organisation will sustain the gains of the REAP after its completion. (TIP: Based on our survey, the following factors ensure the effective implementation of REAP: the goals of the REAP should align with the goals of the Host Organisation and the Host Organisation is committed to the completion and full implementation of your REAP.)	
Development impact and Sustainability	With billions of pesos being spent in capital expenditure for different rail projects, it increasingly becomes imperative for the Rail UPMO to improve its project management system. When implemented, the proposed REAP will contribute towards the improvement of delivery of public mass transportation infrastructure system being developed in the Greater Capital Region by the Rail UPMO. By continuing to seek for ways to improve the management of the planned and ongoing rail infrastructure projects in the pipeline, we are effectively strengthening the way by which the rail sector can fully deliver the inclusive growth, connectivity, and sustainability agenda of the 2023-2028 Philippine Development Plan. Furthermore, the achievement of these goals shall create more high-productivity employment opportunities in the transportation sector which will contribute to the achievement of our Ambisyon Nation 2040 vision. To be able to sustain the initiative, it will be necessary to draft a guideline and issue a memorandum for all stakeholders to institutionalize the utilization of the tool. The view or feedback of PMOs, stakeholders, attached agencies, and DOTr principals will be important in the creation of the tool so as to make the output responsive to the needs of the beneficiaries. Most importantly, the data points to be identified in the M&E tool for closing of projects should be the guide framework of the sector's overall M&E mechanism. The progress reports of all ongoing projects should already incorporate data which are to be gathered or reported at the end-stage of the project. This requirement shall be lodged in the fine print of the memorandum to be issued, and will be necessary for the sustainability of the initiative. The REAP project output will also include the recommendation to build a library of all 'lessons learned' of all rail infrastructure projects, which will be gathered once the M&E tool is implemented on all recently-finished projects at that time. Over time and with enough resources, it will also serve as the baseline data needed to improve the sector's transparency reporting which are being done under similar projects like the DBM Project DIME and NEDA PIPOL online system.

Organisational Outcome	The proposed REAP will aim to improve systems at the Rail UPMO in its pursuit to implement critical railway infrastructure projects in three ways. First, it will improve the Rail UPMO's project management and performance tracking system. When implemented properly, the use of the output M&E tool should allow the Rail UPMO to evaluate whether the railway projects met their intended goals, quality, or outcomes (including environmental, social, sustainability outcomes) as identified during either feasibility stage or as indicated in the project's past appraisal reports. Secondly, it will also improve the Rail UPMO's data-driven decision-making on other ongoing and future infrastructure projects by banking on the pool of knowledge to be collected through the output project closing M&E tool. The REAP can serve as the starting point for the office to collect lessons learned and identify best practices. Lastly, the REAP will also improve the Rail UPMO's reporting system by ensuring accountability among project stakeholders in tracking of how financial, human, and other resources were utilized throughout the project.
Output	The output of the reap is a project closing monitoring and evaluation tool which shall capture all the lessons learned from all previous projects, and fill in the gap between project implementation and project development or planning. By developing this M&E tool, the Rail UPMO can continuously improve the implementing capacity of the ongoing and future projects while learning from lessons from the past. The output can be a robust source of idea of how to better plan and develop other projects.
Competencies	The success of the proposed REAP relies on the improved competencies which may be gained in further studies such as the Project and Program Management program of the University of Sydney. For instance, the study plan for the abovementioned program includes modules such as Governance and Organisational PM which shall build competencies on planning and control of projects, and provide coverage on topics including monitoring, reporting, and quality management. They also have Project Planning and Delivery, as well as Sustainability and Innovation elective modules which will provide a broader understanding of portfolio and project appraisal and sustainability concepts. Lastly, they also have a core subject focused on Project Leadership and Systems Thinking which will be valuable when approaching and resolving problems in projects. After all, the target output of the REAP serves as a part of a system – the project closing M&E tool will be used at the end-stage of a project to provide insight and impact evaluation as it feeds into project planning and development activities.

III. IMPLEMENTABILITY OF THE REAP. The REAP should be fully implemented within two years from when a scholar returns from Australia. The applicant should clearly and succinctly explain how he/she will implement the REAP within the required timeframe and budget. (TIP: The scale of your REAP should be within your circle of influence and control to ensure doability.)

Measurability

How will you track the progress of the implementation of your REAP? What are your milestones? Divide your REAP activities and timeline into four (4) milestones: 25%, 50%, 75% and 100%.

Action Steps (What activities will contribute to the milestones)	Expected Output	Timeline
25%		
Discovery and data-gathering of project and portfolio targets and other documents such as feasibility studies, project appraisal reports, and NEDA project investment approval evaluation reports, etc.	List of all data points to be captured in the tool	May 2027 – Aug 2027
Consultation with project stakeholders (Project Managers, Planning Office, section/office leads and representatives, etc.) on the initiative	-List of all data points to be captured in the tool -List of all resources needed for the implementation	May 2027 – Aug 2027
50%		
Drafting of outline of the proposed Project Closing M&E tool	Initial draft of the Project Closing M&E Tool	Sep 2027 – Dec 2027
Drafting of guidelines of the proposed format of end-project report	Initial draft of the user guide for the tool	Sep 2027 – Dec 2027
75%		
Review draft and solicit feedback from project stakeholders	Version 2 of the Project Closing M&E Tool	Jan 2028 – Feb 2028
Finalization of draft tool and guidelines	Final M&E Project Closing M&E Tool	Feb 2028
100%		
Drafting of memo/office order	Office Order/ Memorandum issuance about the use of the tool	Mar 2028
Issuance of memo, knowledge-sharing, and implementation	Project Closing Report	Apr 2028 onwards

Resources	To successfully implement the reap, resources needed for clerical activities (printing, archiving, data storage, and other stationery requirements) shall be sourced from the available supply of the Rail UPMO. Representation, communication, and transportation costs shall be charged to available allowances.
REAP Start Date and End Date	May 2027 – April 2028

RISKS AND MITIGATING MEASURE <i>Describe the risks that might impact on the success of the Action Plan and how you plan to manage these to ensure success. (Identify factors that will block/limit/slowdown accomplishment of intended results or lessen quality of outputs.)</i>	
<i>RISK</i>	<i>MITIGATING MEASURE</i>
Unavailability of PMs, officers, stakeholders for consultation and review/feedback sessions	Ask permission to tap deputy PMs and other representatives per office to still get necessary viewpoints.
Delays in finalization of tool due to change in officers, strategy of DOTr	Orient new officers and stakeholders regarding the intention of the REAP, how it falls squarely within the targets of the 2023-2028 PDP

Signed by:


JANINA MARIE C. CAPISTRANO
Name of Proponent

Signed by:


USEC. TIMOTHY JOHN R. BATAN
(Printed name over signature)